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Pet Toy System and Apparatus

Abstract

Embodiments of the present invention are directed toward an improved pet toy system and/or apparatus for cats and other animals comprising an ergonomically shaped handle configured to accept a slender wire-like wand that has a cat (or other animal) toy attached to its distal end and a docking plug interoperably attached or permanently affixed to its proximal end, such that the docking plug (along with its associated wand) can be repeatedly inserted into and removed from a docking seat located within a longitudinal center hole in the handle, thereby facilitating an easy switch between different wands and/or toys while using the same ergonomic handle.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(e) to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/559,530, entitled “Cat Wand Toy Handle,” filed on Feb. 29, 2024.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0002] Embodiments of the present invention relate generally to toys for the entertainment of pets and other animals, and more specifically to a handle apparatus for holding interchangeable wands upon which many different cat and other animal toys can be attached.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Current pet toys are often permanently bound to a handle. This creates an issue, because through the normal use of pet toys, the pet attractor can become damaged and may therefore fall apart over time, necessitating the replacement of the entire pet toy and handle. This wasteful design generates excessive waste and additional costs for the consumer.

[0004] Additionally, pets can have different and shifting preferences, and in order to provide additional stimuli, a pet owner will typically own multiple pet toys, each with its own bound handle. Such a unitary, permanently bound handle design creates logistical problems for consumers in terms of requiring additional space for storing pet toys and increased costs of purchasing multiple toys with handles.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] This summary is provided to introduce certain concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to limit in any way the scope of the claimed invention.

[0006] Embodiments of the present invention provide an improved system and/or apparatus for pet toys (and other animal toys) comprising at least two parts: (1) a handle having a length between 4 and 6 inches with a generally elliptical cross section with a tapered diameter along its length of between 0.5 and 0.7 inches, with an ergonomic shape that can easily be held in a human hand, with an ergonomic indentation having a depth between 0.5 mm and 1.5 mm to allow a person to more easily hold the handle, and including on its distal end an approximately 2 mm to 5 mm opening to a centered internal longitudinal cavity that is approximately 4 to 6 inches deep and approximately 2 mm to 5 mm in diameter; within which (2) a wand of any length featuring a pet toy on its distal end and a docking plug on its proximal end. According to embodiments, the wand can be inserted into the handle, with said docking plug being suitably sized to fit snugly within the longitudinal cavity of the handle. The material of the handle and the docking plug should be sufficiently elastic such that the wand with its connected docking plug can be repeatedly inserted into the handle and removed from the handle without compromising the integrity of the handle cavity. The material of the handle and the docking plug should also be sufficiently rigid to enable the wand to be snugly held in the handle during normal anticipated use. Embodiments may have more than one longitudinal cavity to accommodate more than one wand at a time.

[0007] Embodiments of the present invention also provide an improved handle for pet toys (and other animal toys) comprising at least three parts: (1) a handle having a length between 4 and 6

inches with a generally elliptical cross section with a tapered diameter along its length of between 0.5 and 0.7 inches, with in ergonomic shape that can easily be held in a human hand, with an indentation having a depth between 0.5 mm and 1.5 mm to ergonomically hold the handle, and including on its distal end an approximately 2 mm to 5 mm opening to a centered internal longitudinal cavity that is approximately 4 to 6 inches deep and approximately 2 mm to 5 mm in diameter, within which (2) a docking plug can be inserted into the handle, with said docking plug being suitably sized to fit snugly within the longitudinal cavity of the handle, said docking plug further featuring a longitudinal cavity sized such that (3) a wand or wire of any length holding any number of pet toys can be interchangeably inserted into the docking plug. According to embodiments, the wand can be inserted into the handle, with said docking plug being suitably sized to fit snugly within the longitudinal cavity of the handle. The material of the handle and the docking plug should be sufficiently elastic such that the wand with its connected docking plug can be repeatedly inserted into the handle and removed from the handle without compromising the integrity of the handle cavity. The material of the handle and the docking plug should also be sufficiently rigid to enable the wand to be snugly held in the handle during normal anticipated use. Again, embodiments may have more than one longitudinal cavity to accommodate more than one wand at a time.

[0008] The above summaries of preferred embodiments have been provided to introduce certain concepts and/or features that are further described below in the Detailed Description. The summarized preferred embodiments are not necessarily representative of the claimed invention, nor do they span the scope of features described in more detail below. They simply serve as an introduction.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0009] So that the above summarized features of the present invention can be understood in detail, a more particular description of the invention may be had by reference to embodiments, some of which are illustrated in the appended drawings. It is to be noted, however, that the appended drawings illustrate only typical embodiments of this invention and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, for the invention may admit to other equally effective embodiments.

[0010] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating multiple pet attractors permanently affixed to a wand which is connected to a pet toy handle with an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0011] FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet attractor attached to a wand connected to a pet toy handle with an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0012] FIG. 3 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand attached to a docking plug configured to be inserted into a pet toy handle featuring an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0013] FIG. 4 is an exploded sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand sized to be snugly inserted into a docking plug which features an internal cavity, and a pet toy handle featuring an ergonomic indentation on its distal end and a centered internal longitudinal cavity that substantially matches the docking plug such that the docking plug can be securely nested and snapped in place in accordance with the present invention.

[0014] FIG. 5 is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand snugly inserted through an internal cavity of a

docking plug, which is in turn snugly nested inside a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle that features an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0015] FIG. **6** is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring an opening on its distal end to accept the insertion of pet toy wands, and multiple ergonomic indentations in accordance with the present invention.

[0016] FIG. **7** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring a centered internal longitudinal cavity which is open on the distal end and closed on the proximal end, the longitudinal cavity further featuring a multi-diameter portion at the distal end to serve as a docking seat for accepting and snugly nesting a docking plug in accordance with the present invention.

[0017] FIG. **8** is a perspective axial view looking directly at the distal end of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring a centered internal longitudinal cavity for the insertion of pet toy wands, where the longitudinal cavity is open on the distal end and closed on the proximal end, where the pet toy handle further has a multi-diameter, generally cylindrical, distal end with diametrically opposing ergonomic indentations near the distal end, and the proximal end of the pet toy handle having a generally elliptical cross section with its major axis radially offset from the ergonomic indentations in accordance with the present invention.

[0018] FIG. **9** is a perspective axial view looking directly at the proximal end of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring a closed proximal end which has a generally elliptical cross section, and a generally cylindrical distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0019] FIG. **10** is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a docking plug with a longitudinal cavity for the insertion of a pet toy wand and a center portion having an expanded outer diameter to substantially mirror and match the diameter of a docking plug seat inside a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle such that the docking plug can be securely nested inside the handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0020] FIG. **11** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a vertically symmetric docking plug such that its proximal and distal ends substantially match, allowing it to be orientation-independently inserted into a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle, said symmetric docking plug further having a longitudinal cavity for the insertion of a pet toy wand and a center portion having an expanded outer diameter to substantially mirror and match the diameter of a docking plug seat inside of a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle such that the docking plug can be securely nested inside a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0021] FIG. **12** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand snugly inserted into a longitudinal cavity of a docking plug, which is securely nested within a docking plug seat of a centered internal longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0022] FIG. **13** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating an asymmetric, orientation-dependent docking plug with an expanded distal end inserted into and securely nested within a docking plug seat inside of a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

[0023] Embodiments of the present invention will be described with reference to the accompanying drawings, wherein like parts are designated by like reference numerals throughout, and wherein the leftmost digit(s) of each reference number refers to the drawing number of the figure in which the referenced part first appears. Embodiments of the invention are not limited in their application to the details of construction or to the arrangement of the components set forth in the following description or illustrated in the drawings. Embodiments of the invention are capable of being

practiced and carried out in various ways. In addition, the phraseology and terminology employed herein are for the purpose of description and should not be regarded as limiting.

[0024] As summarized above, preferred embodiments of the present invention provide an improved pet toy wand handle principally comprising a centered internal longitudinal activity configured to accept interchangeable wands to attach pet attractors (the pet attractors themselves are not part of the claimed invention).

Interchangeable Wands to Attach Pet Attractors

[0025] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating multiple pet attractors permanently affixed to a wand which is connected to a pet toy handle with an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0026] More specifically, FIG. 1 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating multiple pet attractors **140** permanently affixed to a wand **130** which is connected to a pet toy handle with an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0027] Referring to FIG. 1, an assembled pet toy system **100** may include handle **110** with interoperably attached wand **130**, inserted into the distal end of handle **110** and pet attractors **140** affixed to the distal end of wand **130**.

[0028] As shown in FIG. 1, handle **110** may feature ergonomic indentation **120** near its distal end.

[0029] As further shown in FIG. 1, wand **130** may feature multiple pet attractors **140** affixed to its distal end.

[0030] Preferentially, handle **110** is operated by a human. Ergonomic indentation **120** on handle **110** may increase the comfort of the operator and may allow the operator to control handle **110** with greater precision and dexterity, given the increased torque the operator may be allowed to apply to handle **110** through ergonomic indentation **120**.

[0031] Preferentially, wand **130** is of a suitable length such that pet attractor **140** is sufficiently distanced from the human operator such that the cat or other animal may does not represent a risk to the operator's safety.

[0032] Preferentially, handle **110** has an ergonomic shape that can easily be held in a human hand. Handle **110** may have a length between 4 and 6 inches with a generally elliptical cross section with a tapered diameter along its length of between 0.5 and 0.7 inches and ergonomic indentation **120** is centered 0.3-0.7 inches away from the distal end of handle **110**. Alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0033] Preferentially, ergonomic indentation **120** has a depth of between 0.5 mm and 1.5 mm. Alternative sizes are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0034] Preferentially, wand **130** has a diameter of between 0.005 and 0.01 inches and a length between 24 and 48 inches. Alternative sizes are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0035] FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet attractor attached to a wand connected to a pet toy handle with an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0036] More specifically, FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating pet attractor **210** attached to wand **130** connected to pet toy handle **110** with ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0037] Referring to FIG. 2, an assembled pet toy system **200** may include handle **110** with interoperably attached wand **130** inserted into the distal end of handle **110**, and pet attractor **210** attached to the distal end of wand **130**.

[0038] As shown in FIG. 2, handle **110** may feature ergonomic indentation **120** near its distal end.

[0039] As further shown in FIG. 2, wand **130** may feature attachable pet attractor **210** at its distal

end.

[0040] Preferentially, handle **110** is operated by a human. Ergonomic indentation **120** on handle **110** may increase the comfort of the operator and may allow the operator to control handle **110** with greater precision and dexterity, given the increased torque the operator may be allowed to apply to handle **110** through the ergonomic indentation **120**.

[0041] Preferentially, wand **130** is of a suitable length such that attachable pet attractor **210** is sufficiently distanced from the human operator such that the cat or other animal may does not represent a risk to the operator's safety.

[0042] Preferred sizes and configurations for preferred exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0043] FIG. **3** is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand attached to a docking plug configured to be inserted into a pet toy handle featuring an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0044] More specifically, FIG. **3** is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating pet toy wand **130** attached to docking plug **310** configured to be inserted into pet toy handle **110** featuring ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0045] Referring to FIG. **3**, an unassembled pet toy system **300** may include handle **110** and pet toy wand **130** affixed to docking plug **310**. Docking plug **310** may be suitably sized to be inserted into the distal end of handle **130**.

[0046] As shown in FIG. **3**, handle **110** may feature ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end. As shown in FIG. **3**, wand **130** does not necessarily include an affixed pet attractor.

[0047] As shown in FIG. **3**, wand **130** may include affixed docking plug **310**.

[0048] Preferentially, handle **110** is operated by a human. Ergonomic indentation **120** on handle **110** may increase the comfort of the operator and may allow the operator to control handle **110** with greater precision and dexterity, given the increased torque the operator may be allowed to apply to handle **110** through the ergonomic indentation **120**.

[0049] Preferentially, handle **110** may feature an open cavity capable of accepting docking plug **310** such that docking plug **310** may be securely held in place through static friction.

[0050] Preferentially, docking plug **310** has a diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm, with a central portion that has a diameter 0.5 mm larger than the rest of docking plug **310** and a length of 0.5 inches. Alternative sizes are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0051] FIG. **4** is an exploded sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand sized to be snugly inserted into a docking plug which features an internal cavity, and a pet toy handle featuring an ergonomic indentation on its distal end and a centered internal longitudinal cavity that substantially matches the docking plug such that the docking plug can be securely nested and snapped in place in accordance with the present invention.

[0052] More specifically, FIG. **4** is an exploded sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating pet toy wand **130** sized to be snugly inserted into a docking plug **310** which features an internal cavity, and pet toy handle **110** featuring ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end and centered internal longitudinal cavity **410** that substantially matches docking plug **310** such that docking plug **310** can be securely nested and snapped in place in accordance with the present invention.

[0053] Referring to FIG. **4**, an unassembled pet toy system **400** may include handle **110**, docking plug **310**, and wand **130**. Handle **110** may include a centered internal longitudinal cavity **410** for retaining holding wand **130** through static friction. Cavity **410** may be configured to accept docking plug **310**, which in turn may be configured to accept and snugly secure wand **130** through static

friction.

[0054] As shown in FIG. 4, handle **130** may feature ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end. As shown in FIG. 4, wand **130** does not necessarily include an affixed pet attractor.

[0055] As shown in FIG. 4, docking plug **310** may be separated from wand **130**.

[0056] Preferentially, handle **110** should be made out of a suitably elastic material as discussed below, such that **310** docking plug may be inserted and removed from handle **110** without causing damage to handle **110** or cavity **410**.

[0057] Preferentially, cavity **410** is sufficiently deep about its vertical axis such that wand **130** can be inserted sufficiently deep such that after wand **130** is inserted into docking plug **310**, wand **130** does not become dislodged from docking plug **310** when a limited pulling force is applied to wand **130**, which may occur during the normal anticipated use of the invention.

[0058] Preferentially, docking plug **310** features a centered internal longitudinal cavity open on both the proximal end and distal end such that wand **130** may be fully inserted into plug **310** and once inserted, wand **130** may be pulled from either the proximal or the distal end.

[0059] Preferentially, docking plug **310** features a centered internal longitudinal cavity is between 0.005 and 0.01 inches in diameter such that wand **130** may be fully inserted into plug **310** but once inserted, wand **130** is held snugly in place through static friction. Again, alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0060] Preferentially, handle **110** features cavity **410** that may have multiple diameters such that docking plug **310** may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, but prevented from being inserted too far into cavity **410** such that the walls of cavity **410** could interfere with the free movement and rotation of wand **130**.

[0061] Preferentially, handle **110** features cavity **410** that has multiple diameters such that docking plug **310** may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, and docking plug **310** is resistant to pulling forces applied to **130** wand which may prevent docking plug **310** from being inadvertently removed from cavity **410** through normal anticipated use of the invention, but not such great resistance that intentionally dislodging docking plug **310** from cavity **410** may be strenuous for the average human.

[0062] Preferentially handle **110** is operated by a human. Ergonomic indentation **120** on handle **110** may increase the comfort of the operator and may allow the operator to control handle **110** with greater precision and dexterity, given the increased torque the operator may be allowed to apply to handle **110** through the ergonomic indentation **120**.

[0063] Preferred sizes and configurations for preferred exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0064] FIG. 5 is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand snugly inserted through an internal cavity of a docking plug, which is in turn snugly nested inside a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle that features an ergonomic indentation on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0065] More specifically, FIG. 5 is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating pet toy wand **130** snugly inserted through an internal cavity of docking plug **310**, which is in turn snugly nested inside longitudinal cavity **410** of pet toy handle **110** that features ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0066] Referring to FIG. 5, an assembled pet toy system **500** may include handle **110**, docking plug **310**, and wand **130**. Wand **130** is snugly inserted through an internal cavity of docking plug **310**, which is in turn snugly nested in docking plug seat **510** inside of longitudinal cavity **410** of handle **110**.

[0067] As shown in FIG. 5. docking plug **310** and longitudinal cavity **410** of handle **110** may

substantially match such that docking plug **310** substantially fills and may be securely nested within designated docking plug seat **510** of longitudinal cavity **410** of handle **110**.

[0068] As shown in FIG. 5, wand **130** does not necessarily include an affixed pet attractor.

[0069] As shown in FIG. 5, handle **110** may feature ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end.

[0070] Preferentially, handle **110** should be made out of a suitably elastic material such that **310** docking plug may be inserted and removed from handle **110** without causing damage to handle **110** or cavity **410**.

[0071] Preferentially, cavity **410** is sufficiently deep along its vertical axis such that wand **130** can be inserted sufficiently deep such that after wand **130** is inserted into docking plug **310**, wand **130** does not become dislodged from docking plug **310** when a limited pulling force is applied to wand **130**.

[0072] Preferentially, docking plug **310** features a centered internal longitudinal cavity open on both the proximal end and distal end such that wand **130** may be fully inserted into plug **310** and once inserted, wand **130** may be pulled from either the proximal or the distal end.

[0073] Preferentially, cavity **410** features docking seat **510** that has multiple diameters such that docking plug **310** may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, but the stepped diameter of docking plug seat **510** prevents docking plug **310** from being inserted too far into cavity **410** such that the walls of cavity **410** could interfere with the free movement and rotation of wand **130**.

[0074] Preferentially, cavity **410** features docking seat **510** that has multiple diameters such that docking plug **310** may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, but the smaller distal diameter of cavity **410** prevents docking plug **310** from being inadvertently pulled out removed from cavity **410** through normal anticipated use of the invention, but the smaller distal diameter of cavity **410** does not prevent the average human from intentionally dislodging docking plug **310** from cavity **410** without strenuous exertion.

[0075] Preferentially, handle **110** is operated by a human. Ergonomic indentation **120** on handle **110** may increase the comfort of the operator and may allow the operator to control handle **110** with greater precision and dexterity, given the increased torque the operator may be allowed to apply to handle **110** through the ergonomic indentation **120**.

[0076] Preferred sizes and configurations for certain exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible; these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of certain exemplar embodiments.

[0077] FIG. 6 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring an opening on its distal end to accept the insertion of pet toy wands, and multiple ergonomic indentations in accordance with the present invention.

[0078] More specifically, FIG. 6 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring an opening on its distal end **610** to accept the insertion of pet toy wands, distal ergonomic indentation **120** and multiple proximal ergonomic indentations **620** in accordance with the present invention.

[0079] Referring to FIG. 6, a pet toy handle apparatus **600** may include a distal end opening **610** to accept the insertion of pet toy wands, ergonomic indentation **610** on the distal end, and multiple ergonomic indentations **620** on the proximal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0080] As shown in FIG. 6, handle **110** may feature ergonomic indentation **120** on its distal end.

[0081] As shown in FIG. 6, handle **110** may feature multiple ergonomic indentation(s) **620** on its proximal end.

[0082] Preferred sizes and configurations for certain exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible; these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of certain exemplar embodiments.

[0083] Preferentially, handle **110** has multiple proximal end ergonomic indentation(s) **620** that are located 1 inch, 1.5 inches, and 2 inches from the proximal end of handle **110**. Proximal end ergonomic indentation(s) **620** may have a depth between 0.5 mm and 1.5 mm. Alternative sizes are

possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments. [0084] FIG. 7 is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring a centered internal longitudinal cavity which is open on the distal end and closed on the proximal end, the longitudinal cavity further featuring a multi-diameter portion at the distal end to serve as a docking seat for accepting and snugly nesting a docking plug in accordance with the present invention.

[0085] More specifically, FIG. 7 is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating pet toy handle **110** featuring a centered internal longitudinal cavity **410** which is open on the distal end and closed on the proximal end, the longitudinal cavity further featuring a multi-diameter portion at the distal end to serve as a docking seat **510** for accepting and snugly nesting a docking plug in accordance with the present invention.

[0086] Referring to FIG. 7, a pet toy handle without a wand or docking plug **700** may include a handle **110** having longitudinal cavity **410** including a docking plug seat **510** that has multiple diameters such that docking plug seat **510** may accept and through static friction securely hold insertable docking plugs.

[0087] As shown in FIG. 7, handle **110** may not include an ergonomic indentation.

[0088] Preferentially, handle **110** may have a closed proximal end.

[0089] Preferentially, cavity **410** features docking seat **510** that has multiple diameters such that a docking plug may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, but the stepped diameter of docking plug seat **510** may prevent a docking plug from being inserted too far into cavity **410** such that the walls of cavity **410** could interfere with the free movement and rotation of a pet toy wand.

[0090] Preferentially, cavity **410** features docking seat **510** that may have multiple diameters such that a docking plug may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, but the smaller distal diameter of cavity **410** prevents a docking plug from being inadvertently pulled out and removed from cavity **410** through normal anticipated use of the invention, but the smaller distal diameter of cavity **410** does not prevent the average human from intentionally dislodging a docking plug from cavity **410** without strenuous exertion.

[0091] Preferred sizes for handle **110** for use in preferred exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0092] Preferentially, docking plug seat **510** may have a generally cylindrical diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm, with a central portion that has a diameter 0.5 mm larger than the rest of docking plug seat **510**. Alternative sizes are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0093] FIG. 8 is a perspective axial view looking directly at the distal end of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring a centered internal longitudinal cavity for the insertion of pet toy wands, where the longitudinal cavity is open on the distal end and closed on the proximal end, where the pet toy handle further has a multi-diameter, generally cylindrical, distal end with diametrically opposing ergonomic indentations near the distal end, and the proximal end of the pet toy handle having a generally elliptical cross section with its major axis radially offset from the ergonomic indentations in accordance with the present invention.

[0094] More specifically, FIG. 8 is a perspective axial view looking directly at the distal end of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle (**810, 820, 830, 840**) featuring a centered internal longitudinal cavity **410** for the insertion of pet toy wands, where the longitudinal cavity **410** is open on the distal end and closed on the proximal end, where the pet toy handle further has a multi-diameter, generally cylindrical, distal end (**830, 840**) with diametrically opposing ergonomic indentations **120** near the distal end **840**, and the proximal end **810** of the pet toy handle having a generally elliptical cross section with its major axis radially offset from the ergonomic indentations **120** in accordance with the present invention.

[0095] Referring to FIG. 8, a pet toy handle apparatus **800** may include centered internal longitudinal cavity **410** for the insertion of pet toy wands. Handle **110** may include flat top **830**, generally cylindrical distal end **840**, slightly larger middle portion **820**, proximal end with a generally elliptical cross section **810**. Middle portion **820** may have diametrically opposing ergonomic indentions **120** and proximal end **810** may be radially offset about its major axis from ergonomic indentions **120** such that handle **110** may be more comfortable for a user. Handle may also include longitudinal cavity **410**, cavity **410** may be open on the distal end and closed on the proximal end.

[0096] Preferentially, handle top **830** is flat with a diameter of between 0.25 and 0.5 inches.

[0097] Preferentially, handle distal portion **840** is generally cylindrical with a diameter of between 0.25 and 0.5 inches.

[0098] Preferentially, handle middle portion **820** is generally cylindrical with a diameter of between 0.2 and 0.3 inches.

[0099] Preferentially, handle proximal portion **810** has a generally elliptical cross section with a tapered major axis of width of between 0.5 and 0.7 inches with the major axis radially offset from ergonomic indentations **120** by between 25 and 65 degrees.

[0100] Again, alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0101] FIG. 9 is a perspective axial view looking directly at the proximal end of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring a closed proximal end which has a generally elliptical cross section, and a generally cylindrical distal end in accordance with the present invention.

[0102] More specifically, FIG. 9 is a perspective axial view looking directly at the proximal end **910** of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy handle featuring a closed proximal end **910** which has a generally elliptical cross section, and a generally cylindrical distal end **920** in accordance with the present invention.

[0103] Referring to FIG. 9, a pet toy handle apparatus **900** may include closed proximal end **910** with a generally elliptical cross section and a generally cylindrical distal end **920**.

[0104] Preferred sizes and configurations for preferred exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0105] FIG. 10 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a docking plug with a longitudinal cavity for the insertion of a pet toy wand and a center portion having an expanded outer diameter to substantially match the diameter of a docking plug seat inside a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle such that the docking plug can be securely nested inside the handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0106] More specifically, FIG. 10 is a perspective view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating docking plug **1000** featuring a longitudinal cavity **1010** for the insertion of a pet toy wand and a center portion **1030** having an expanded outer diameter to substantially match the diameter of a docking plug seat inside a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle such that the docking plug can be securely nested inside the handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0107] Referring to FIG. 10, docking plug **1000** may feature a centered longitudinal cavity **1010** for the insertion of a pet toy wand, docking plug expansion **1030**, proximal end **1040**, and distal end **1020**.

[0108] Preferentially, cavity **1010** is open on both proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020**.

[0109] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** have substantially similar diameter such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0110] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** have substantially similar longitudinal length such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the

user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0111] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** has a larger diameter than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be inserted into a pet toy handle and securely nested into a docking plug seat.

[0112] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** is situated equally distant from the docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0113] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** may have a diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm, docking plug expansion **1030** has a diameter 0.5 mm larger than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020**, alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0114] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a sufficient longitudinal length to withstand the frictional forces experienced by inserting and removing docking plug **1000** from the docking plug seat and handle discussed above. A docking plug expansion is more likely to experience structure failure from said forces the greater the difference between the longitudinal length of docking plug expansion **1030** and the increased diameter of docking plug expansion compared to the diameter of docking plug distal end and docking plug proximal end.

[0115] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.2 and 0.4 inches, docking plug proximal end **1040** has a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, and docking plug distal end **1020** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0116] FIG. **11** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a vertically symmetric docking plug such that its proximal and distal ends substantially match, allowing it to be orientation-independently inserted into a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle, said symmetric docking plug further having a longitudinal cavity for the insertion of a pet toy wand and a center portion having an expanded outer diameter to substantially match the diameter of a docking plug seat inside of a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle such that the docking plug can be securely nested inside a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0117] More specifically, FIG. **11** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a vertically symmetric docking plug **1100** such that its proximal **1040** and distal ends **1020** substantially match, allowing it to be orientation-independently inserted into a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle, said symmetric docking plug further having a longitudinal cavity for the insertion of a pet toy wand and a center portion **1030** having an expanded outer diameter to substantially match the diameter of a docking plug seat inside of a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle such that the docking plug can be securely nested inside a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0118] Referring to FIG. **11**, docking plug **1100** may feature a centered longitudinal cavity **1010** for the insertion of a pet toy wand, docking plug expansion **1030**, proximal end **1040**, and distal end **1020**.

[0119] Preferentially, cavity **1010** may be open on both proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020**.

[0120] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** may have substantially similar diameter such that docking plug **1100** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0121] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** may have substantially similar longitudinal length such that docking plug **1100** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0122] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a larger diameter than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be inserted into a pet toy handle and securely nested into a docking plug seat.

[0123] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may be situated equally distant from the docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0124] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** have a diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm, docking plug expansion **1030** has a diameter 0.5 mm larger than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020**.

[0125] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a sufficient longitudinal length withstand the frictional forces experienced by inserting and removing docking plug **1100** from the docking plug seat and handle discussed above. A docking plug expansion is more likely to experience structure failure from said forces the greater the difference between the longitudinal length of docking plug expansion **1030** and the increased diameter of docking plug expansion compared to the diameter of docking plug distal end and docking plug proximal end.

[0126] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.2 and 0.4 inches, docking plug proximal end **1040** has a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, and docking plug distal end **1020** has a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0127] FIG. **12** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand snugly inserted into a longitudinal cavity of a docking plug, which is securely nested within a docking plug seat of a centered internal longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0128] More specifically, FIG. **12** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating a pet toy wand **130** snugly inserted into a longitudinal cavity of a docking plug, which is securely nested within a docking plug seat **510** of a centered internal longitudinal cavity **410** of a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0129] Referring to FIG. **12**, an inserted docking plug system **1200** may include docking plug **310**, wand **130**, and cavity **410**. Wand **130** may be inserted through an internal cavity of docking plug **310** and held in place through static friction, docking plug **310** may then in turn be snugly nested in docking plug seat **510** inside of cavity **410** and held in place through static friction and mated geometry of docking plug seat **510** and docking plug **310**.

[0130] As shown in FIG. **12**, a cavity **410** may include docking plug seat **510** which may include docking plug seat distal end **1220**, docking plug seat expansion **1230**, and docking plug proximal end **1240**.

[0131] As shown in FIG. **12**, the diameter of docking plug seat expansion **1230** may substantially match the diameter of docking plug expansion **1030** such that docking plug **310** can snugly secured within cavity **410** through static friction.

[0132] As shown in FIG. **12**, the diameter of docking plug seat distal end **1220** may substantially match the diameter of docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **310** can snugly secured within cavity **410** through static friction.

[0133] As shown in FIG. **12**, the diameter of docking plug seat proximal end **1240** may substantially match the diameter of docking plug proximal end **1040** such that docking plug **310** can snugly secured within cavity **410** through static friction.

[0134] Preferentially, cavity **410** features docking seat **510** that may have multiple diameters such that docking plug **310** may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, but the stepped diameter of docking plug seat **510** may prevent docking plug **310** from being inserted too far into cavity **410** such that

the walls of cavity **410** could interfere with the free movement and rotation of wand **130**.

[0135] Preferentially, cavity **410** features docking seat **510** that may have multiple diameters such that docking plug **310** may be firmly inserted into cavity **410**, but the smaller distal diameter of cavity **410** may prevent docking plug **310** from being inadvertently pulled out removed from cavity **410** through normal anticipated use of the invention, but the smaller distal diameter of cavity **410** does not prevent the average human from intentionally dislodging docking plug **310** from cavity **410** without strenuous exertion.

[0136] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** may have substantially similar diameters such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0137] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** may have a substantially similar longitudinal length such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0138] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a larger diameter than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be inserted into a pet toy handle and securely nested into a docking plug seat.

[0139] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may be situated equally distant from the docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0140] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** may have a diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a diameter 0.5 mm larger than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020**, alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0141] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a sufficient longitudinal length withstand the frictional forces experienced by inserting and removing docking plug **310** from the docking plug seat and handle discussed above. A docking plug expansion is more likely to experience structure failure from said forces the greater the difference between the longitudinal length of docking plug expansion **1030** and the increased diameter of docking plug expansion compared to the diameter of docking plug distal end and docking plug proximal end.

[0142] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.2 and 0.4 inches, docking plug proximal end **1040** has a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, and docking plug distal end **1020** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0143] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** may have substantially similar diameter such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0144] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** may have substantially similar longitudinal length such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0145] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a larger diameter than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be inserted into a pet toy handle and securely nested into a docking plug seat.

[0146] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may be situated equally distant from the docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** such that docking plug **1000** may be orientationally independent and the user would not have to distinguish between proximal end **1040** and distal end **1020** in ordinary use.

[0147] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020** may have a diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a diameter 0.5 mm larger than docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug distal end **1020**, alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0148] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a sufficient longitudinal length withstand the frictional forces experienced by inserting and removing docking plug **1000** from the docking plug seat and handle discussed above. A docking plug expansion is more likely to experience structure failure from said forces the greater the difference between the longitudinal length of docking plug expansion **1030** and the increased diameter of docking plug expansion compared to the diameter of docking plug distal end and docking plug proximal end.

[0149] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.2 and 0.4 inches, docking plug proximal end **1040** has a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, and docking plug distal end **1020** has a longitudinal length of between 0.05 and 0.15 inches, alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0150] Preferentially, docking plug expansion **1030** may have a longitudinal length that substantially matches the longitudinal length of docking plug seat expansion **1230** such that docking plug **310** may be more resistant to movement in the event wand **130** is pushed or pulled during use.

[0151] Preferentially, docking plug distal end **1020** may have a longitudinal length that substantially matches the longitudinal length of docking plug seat distal end **1220** such that when inserted docking plug **310** is flush with the top of the pet toy handle, however this is not necessary.

[0152] Preferred sizes and configurations for preferred exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0153] FIG. **13** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating an asymmetric, orientation-dependent docking plug with an expanded distal end inserted into and securely nested within a docking plug seat inside of a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0154] More specifically, FIG. **13** is a sideways/sagittal cross-sectional view of an exemplary embodiment of the present invention illustrating an asymmetric, orientation-dependent docking plug **1300** with an expanded distal end **1320** inserted into and securely nested within a docking plug seat **1310** inside of a longitudinal cavity of a pet toy handle in accordance with the present invention.

[0155] Referring to FIG. **13**, a distal end of a pet toy handle with an inserted asymmetric docking plug **1300** may include docking plug **310** and docking plug seat **1310**. Docking plug **310** may include docking plug expanded distal end **1320** and docking plug proximal end **1040**. Docking plug **130** may then in turn be snugly nested in docking plug seat **510** inside of cavity **410**.

[0156] As shown in FIG. **13** docking plug seat **1310** may include multiple diameters that substantially match the diameter of docking plug expanded distal end **1320** and docking plug proximal end **1040** such that docking plug **310** will be snugly secured through static friction.

[0157] Preferentially, docking plug seat **1310** may have multiple diameters such that docking plug **310** may be firmly inserted, but the varying diameter of docking plug seat **1310** and docking plug proximal end **1040** may prevent docking plug **310** from being inserted too far into the handle that the walls of the handle cavity could interfering with the free movement and rotation of the pet toy wand.

[0158] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** and docking plug expanded distal end **1320** may have substantially different diameters such that docking plug **310** is orientationally dependent and the user would be capable of easily distinguishing between proximal end **1040** and distal end

1320 in ordinary use.

[0159] Preferentially, docking plug proximal end **1040** may have a diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm and docking plug expanded distal end **1320** has a diameter 0.5 mm larger than docking plug proximal end **1040**. Alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0160] Preferentially, docking plug expanded distal end **1040** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.2 and 0.4 inches and docking plug proximal end **1040** may have a longitudinal length of between 0.15 and 0.3 inches. Alternative sizes and configurations are possible, these noted measurements are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0161] Preferred sizes and configurations for preferred exemplar embodiments are discussed throughout and alternative sizes and arrangements are possible, these noted measurements and configurations are merely those of preferred exemplar embodiments.

[0162] The docking plug portion(s) of embodiments may be disconnected or pulled out of the docking plug hole(s) of the handle portion of embodiments. The handle portion of embodiments may therefore accept many different plugs with many different associated wands and/or toys.

Manufacturing

[0163] Both the handle portion and plug portion(s) of embodiments may be made from TPR/TPE (thermoplastic rubber or thermoplastic elastomer), rubbers, plastics, wood composite materials, or any variation or substitute thereof known by those knowledgeable in the art.

Variations

[0164] The handle portion of embodiments may be tapered and/or formed into an ergonomic shape for ease of use, as shown in the Figures.

[0165] Both the handle portion and plug portion(s) of embodiments may be colorized, differently or identically.

[0166] The handle portion of embodiments may comprise more than one docking plug hole and may therefore accept and hold more than one plug and more than one associated toy wand.

[0167] Although the present disclosure provides certain embodiments and applications, other embodiments apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art, including embodiments that do not provide all of the features and advantages set forth herein, are also within the scope of this disclosure.

[0168] The foregoing disclosure has been set forth merely to illustrate the invention and is not intended to be limiting. It will be appreciated that modifications, variations, and additional embodiments are covered by the above teachings and within the purview of the appended claims without departing from the spirit and intended scope of the invention. Since modification of the disclosed embodiments incorporating the spirit and substance of the invention may occur to persons skilled in the art, the invention should be construed to include everything within the scope of the appended claims and equivalents thereof.

Claims

1. A pet toy apparatus comprising: A pet toy handle having a tapered diameter along its length, said tapered diameter broader at the proximal end of the handle and narrower at the distal end of the handle; said handle having a generally cylindrical distal end; said handle having a proximal end with a generally elliptical cross section; said handle having a centered internal longitudinal cavity that is open at the distal end and closed at the proximal end of the handle; and wherein said cavity has an internal notched docking seat configured to accept a pet toy wand.

2. The pet toy apparatus of claim 1, further comprising a pet toy wand configured to accept at least one pet attractor at the distal end of the wand, and where the wand has a diameter at its proximal end that substantially matches the diameter of the cavity of the handle, such that the wand can be inserted into and affixed inside the cavity.

3. The pet toy apparatus of claim 2, wherein the notched docking seat is located between 5 mm and 12 mm from the distal end of the cavity, and where the notched docking seat is between 0.1 mm and 0.2 mm larger in diameter than the cylindrical diameter of the rest of the cavity.
 4. The pet toy apparatus of claim 3, wherein the wand further comprise an external notched docking plug enlargement at the proximal end of the wand that substantially mirrors the shape of the notched docking seat and is configured to snap into the notched docking seat.
 5. The pet toy apparatus of claim 4, wherein the handle is made of a suitably elastic material such that the docking plug may be repeatedly inserted into and or removed from the docking seat without permanently altering the diameter of the docking seat or otherwise compromising the integrity of the docking plug and the docking seat.
 6. The pet toy apparatus of claim 1, where said handle has an ergonomic indentation near the distal end of the handle.
 7. The pet toy apparatus of claim 6, where said ergonomic indentation has a depth of between 0.5 mm and 1.5 mm.
 8. The pet toy apparatus of claim 1, where the handle has a length of between 4 and 6 inches.
 9. The pet toy apparatus of claim 1, where the tapered diameter is between 0.5 and 0.7 inches.
 10. The pet toy apparatus of claim 1, where said cavity has a substantially cylindrical diameter of between 2 mm and 5 mm and a length inside the handle of between 2 and 4 inches.
 11. The pet toy apparatus of claim 2, where the wand has a length of between 6 and 24 inches.
 12. A pet toy apparatus comprising: a pet toy handle, said handle having a tapered diameter along its length, said tapered diameter being broader at the proximal end of the handle and narrower at the distal end of the handle, said handle having a generally cylindrical distal end, said handle having a proximal end with a generally elliptical cross section, said handle having a centered internal longitudinal cavity that is open at the distal end and closed at the proximal end of the handle, and wherein said cavity has an internal notched docking seat configured to accept a pet toy wand; a docking plug configured to be affixed in the distal end the cavity such that when it is inserted, its distal end is substantially flush with the distal end of the handle, said docking plug having a diameter that substantially matches the diameter of the cavity, said docking plug having a centered internal longitudinal cavity, said docking plug having an externally notched enlargement that substantially matches the internally notched docking seat of the longitudinal cavity in the handle, and said docking plug having a length less than the length of the cavity; and a pet toy wand interoperably affixed to the docking plug at the proximal end of the wand and interoperably connected to a pet attractor at the distal end of the wand, said pet toy wand having a diameter that substantially matches the diameter of the longitudinal cavity of the handle.
 13. The pet toy apparatus of claim 12, where said handle has an ergonomic indentation near the distal end of the handle.
 14. A pet toy system comprising: a pet toy handle having a tapered diameter along its length, said tapered diameter being broader at the proximal end of the handle and narrower at the distal end of the handle; a pet toy wand having pet attractor at the distal end of the wand; and means for connecting the proximal end of the pet toy wand to the distal end of the pet toy handle.
 15. The pet toy system of claim 14, said handle comprising an ergonomic indentation near the distal end of the handle.
 16. The pet toy system of claim 15, where said ergonomic indentation has a depth of between 0.5 mm and 1.5 mm.
 17. The pet toy system of claim 14, where the handle has a length of between 4 and 6 inches.
 18. The pet toy system of claim 14, where the tapered diameter is between 0.5 and 0.7 inches.
 19. The pet toy system of claim 14, where the wand has a length of between 6 and 24 inches.
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